Democrats Take Control of Congress in the Midterm Elections

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Voters across the United States have given Democrats control of both houses of Congress. Results from the **midterm elections**, which closed on Tuesday, showed Democrats winning the **House of Representatives** as well as the Senate.

Midterm elections happen halfway through a president's four-year term, when all House seats and about a third of Senate seats are decided. This time, the results were widely seen as a setback for President Donald Trump and his Republican Party, which had previously held both chambers.

According to the Associated Press, voters were motivated by concerns including high prices, the war involving Iran, and questions about government **corruption**. Democrats won races in states from Texas to Iowa to New Hampshire, including some states Trump had won by large margins two years earlier.

Democratic leaders welcomed the outcome. Senate leader Chuck Schumer called it a "generational remake of the Senate map," while House leader Hakeem Jeffries said "the American people are crying out for transformational change."

President Trump said he would accept the results. He also said he would **veto** legislation passed by the Democratic-controlled Congress, and said voters "didn't like the candidates." Republican leaders said they would work with the president to block Democratic proposals they opposed.

Democratic leaders have said they plan to investigate members of the Trump administration and examine how the president's family has benefited from his time in office. They have also said removing Trump or his Cabinet officials from office through **impeachment** is not ruled out.

The new balance of power means the president's final two years in office are likely to involve much more debate, and much closer checks, from Congress.

Word Treasure

midterm elections -- Elections held in the middle of a president's four-year term, when voters choose members of Congress.

House of Representatives -- One of the two chambers of Congress, whose members are elected from districts across the country.

veto -- A president's power to block a law passed by Congress so it does not take effect.

impeachment -- A process in which Congress charges a president or official with wrongdoing and can remove them from office.

corruption -- Dishonest or illegal behavior by people in power, such as using their job for personal gain.

Background you need

Midterm elections are held halfway through a president's four-year term, when voters choose the whole House of Representatives and about a third of the Senate.

Congress makes the country's laws, and the president can block laws by vetoing them, so control of Congress decides how easily a president can pass plans.

When Congress and the president are on opposite sides, Congress can also investigate the president's team much more closely.

That is why a midterm result can change the balance of power for the rest of a president's time in office.

Break it down

LEAD: Democrats win control of both houses of Congress in the midterms
KEY EVENT: Tuesday's midterm election results
+- WHO: Voters across the United States; Democrats; President Trump and the Republicans
+- WHY: Concerns over high prices, the war involving Iran and government corruption, according to the Associated Press
REACTIONS: Democratic leaders welcome the result; Trump accepts it but promises vetoes
OPEN QUESTION: How the new balance of power will change the president's final two years

Why it matters

Control of Congress decides which laws can pass and how closely the president is checked, so this result will shape rules and prices that affect families across the country.

Test what you remember

1. What did Democrats win in the midterm elections?

(A) Only the House of Representatives
(B) Control of both the House and the Senate
(C) Only the Senate
(D) The presidency

2. When do midterm elections happen?

(A) Right after a president is elected
(B) Only when a president resigns
(C) Halfway through a president's four-year term
(D) Every single year

3. According to the Associated Press, which concern motivated many voters?

(A) Space exploration
(B) New video games
(C) Sports results
(D) High prices

4. What did President Trump say he would do with legislation passed by the Democratic-controlled Congress?

(A) Ask other countries to decide
(B) Veto it
(C) Sign all of it quickly
(D) Ignore it completely

5. What have Democratic leaders said they plan to do?

(A) Investigate members of the Trump administration
(B) Cancel the next election
(C) Raise the president's pay
(D) Leave Congress

6. What is likely to change in the president's final two years?

(A) The president will gain more power
(B) Nothing at all
(C) Elections will stop
(D) Congress will debate more and check the president more closely

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: C 3: D 4: B 5: A 6: D

Questions to think about

1. Democratic leaders: Welcomed the outcome, calling it a generational remake of the Senate map and a cry for transformational change.

2. President Trump: Said he would accept the results, blamed the candidates, and said he would veto legislation passed by the Democratic-controlled Congress.

3. Republican leaders: Said they would work with the president to block Democratic proposals they opposed.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):